



Parish News

Kington, Huntington & Titley

June 2026

£1

THE KINGTON PARISHES



**St Mary, Kington; St Thomas a Becket, Huntington
St Stephen, Old Radnor; St Mary, Kinnerton; St Peter, Titley**
www.kingtonparishes.org.uk

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St. Mary's, Kington PCC is a registered charity and its number is 1185453

New!

Stay and Play

Baby & Toddler Group

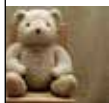
**For parents and carers with
children aged 0-3, no booking
required.**

St Mary's Parish Hall

(parking at rear)

Tuesdays 9:15-10:45

Term Time Only



**Light refreshments, stories and
songs, lots of toys, themed activities.**

**Group provided by St Mary's Kington PCC. Suggested
donation £2**



From our Vicar



In the medieval heyday of pilgrimage, it was common for pilgrims to make the journey to Jerusalem, Rome or other major sites on behalf of others

who were unable to travel. On arrival at the destination, the pilgrim would offer prayers in the name of those left behind, while those at home prayed in turn for the travellers' safe return. Similarly, the recent three-day pilgrim journey round the Benefice which took place as part of Kington Walking Festival, was made special by the hospitality shown by each of the church communities to the visiting pilgrims. The tea, cake and general encouragement were truly valued by the walkers, who left each church refreshed in body and spirit.

'They also serve who only stand and wait' has become a bit overworn, but the principle is still good. John Milton wrote Sonnet 19 in a mood of sadness at his loss of sight which he felt was preventing him from serving God the best way he knew – through his writing. But he reminds himself, and us, that God doesn't need us to do anything for him "God doth not need Either man's work or his own gifts;...His state is Kingly'. All God requires is that we live up to our potential – whether that potential is world-changing or more limited. Those who make the most of what they have 'serve Him best'.

Sometimes we serve others best not through our own adventures, but by encouraging and supporting others in theirs. My grateful thanks to all who helped bring to fruition the Kington Benefice Pilgrimage; look out for the return of our monthly 'third Sunday' pilgrimages, beginning on 21 June at 2.00pm, from St Stephen's Old Radnor.

Sally

– Kington Creations –

St Mary's Lego Club

Thousands of bricks, Lots of mini figures,
Loads of fun !

Wednesday 17th June

3:30pm – 5:00pm

St Mary's Church Kington

Young children to be accompanied
by an adult please

Refreshments available

legoclub.kington@gmail.com

Having fun creating together

From the Archdeacon of Hereford

One of the things I have not quite got used to since living in Herefordshire is the multi culturalism of a large city. We simply don't have the diversity of faiths and culture our more metropolitan areas take for granted. Difference can bring great benefits and the opportunities to discover cultures and traditions other than our own. Yet if we are not careful the politics of division and hatred can draw attention to cultural diversity in an unhelpful way which creates tension and divides communities.

So, the question I want to pose is how do you cope with difference? We all think we are good at dealing with diversity, but the reality is that most of us like and feel most comfortable with people just like us! We all have a certain amount of preference and bias, and it is important that we know how to spot our blind spots and the issues that can trip us up. Yet the bible speaks about difference in a positive way because it recognises all of us are unique expressions of God's love.

In the very beginning of creation God created diversity and difference not just in humanity but in the entire creation. However, uniquely, he created human beings to reflect his divine nature. Whatever preferences we have, at heart we are called to treat others as we ourselves want to be treated. When we reject those who are different, we are in effect rejecting God's love for our world.

"Love the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul and with all your mind and with all your strength. 'The second is this: 'Love your neighbour as yourself.' There is no commandment greater than these."

Mark 12:30-31

Paul recognised that difference was a key part of our faith. Christians are called to live counter culturally and that alone marks us as different from those around us. Our values are

shaped by the kingdom and in the kingdom the differences that matter in this world are meaningless.

Instead, Paul wants us to know that what is important is our trust in Jesus as our Lord because this enables us to be citizens of heaven.

"So in Christ Jesus you are all children of God through faith, for all of you who were baptized into Christ have clothed yourselves with Christ. There is neither Jew nor Gentile, neither slave nor free, nor is there male and female, for you are all one in Christ Jesus. If you belong to Christ, then you are Abraham's seed, and heirs according to the promise."

Galatians 3:26-29

Finally when we look elsewhere in the New Testament, we also find a similar message, in fact John goes further in his letters because he says if we love God but hate those we can see then our faith is flawed. John says when we reject difference, we have not let our faith shape who we are.

"We love because he first loved us. Whoever claims to love God yet hates a brother or sister is a liar. For whoever does not love their brother and sister, whom they have seen, cannot love God, whom they have not seen. And he has given us this command: Anyone who loves God must also love their brother and sister."

1 John 4:19-21

The Venerable Derek Chedzey



St. Mary's Church, Kington

I am writing this a few days after a busy weekend at St. Mary's.

Over the Early May Bank Holiday we hosted the Marches Makers exhibition, when over 1,000 people came to the church to look at the artwork. As you might imagine, the church was very full all weekend. A very successful concert was also held on the Saturday evening.

Several of St. Mary's congregation also held a Cake and Bakes stall at the Hergest Croft Spring Plant fair, which raised nearly £600 for church funds, an amazing result.

Concerts at St. Mary's

We are hosting several concerts over the rest of 2026, beginning on Friday June 12th at 7pm. More details will be advertised shortly, probably somewhere else in this magazine....

Pilgrimages

Benefice pilgrimages will be taking place over the summer, between June and September. Each walk between 3 and 5 miles long, ending with tea in church. Kington's pilgrimage will be held in September. Do come along.

Memorial Garden Hedge

You may have noticed the beginnings of a hedge around part of the garden, which we hope will eventually be around 12 to 18 inches tall, and make a neat edging to the memorials.

Church Carpets

I expect many of you have noticed when you come into the church, that our carpets are wearing out.

They are also keeping the floor rather damp, which is not good for the tiles. So over the



next few weeks we are going to lift the carpets, to allow the floor to dry out before our quinquennial inspection at the end of June. Our church architect will then be able to give us advice about how to best care for the floor, and particularly the chancel tiles. Do come and see what is below the carpets if you are interested.... The church is open from 9am daily, with DIY coffee, tea and biscuits.

All our usual activities are carrying on over the summer -

Beetle Drive 2nd Tuesday of the month at 7pm in the Parish Hall.

Wild Church on 2nd Sunday of the month at 3pm in the Vicarage garden.

Stay and Play baby and toddler group, Tuesdays at 9.15 in the Parish Hall during term time.

Lego Club, usually 3rd Wednesday of the month at 3.30 in church.

Holiday Club during half terms and school holidays in church. (Watch out for posters)

With our very best wishes to you all,

Margaret Cooke and Greg Wright,
churchwardens.

**For all advertising
enquiries please contact:**
pn.kingtonparishes@gmail.com

Cakes & bakes stall

At the *Spring Fair* at **Hergest Croft Gardens** the **St Mary's Church Cakes & Bakes** stall raised the impressive sum of £570.50 for church funds. We would like to thank everyone who helped in any way by making cakes, buying on the day and especially Paul, Nick and Michael who organised the setting up and taking down of the gazebo. We look forward to repeating this achievement at the Autumn Fair in October.

Freda, Alison and Debbie

The Yarn Barn

37 High Street
Kington

Grand Opening

Monday 1 June

10am – 12 noon

Weaving Demonstrations

Tea & Coffee available

Wednesday 3 June

10am – 12 noon

Have a Go at Weaving

All Welcome

Operation Dove

The planning application is still grinding on as I write this on May 10th, but hopefully by the time that you're reading this Parish News significant progress may have been made. However, a lot of things have been happening in the courtyard and in the Yarn Barn. We now have a new toilet located in the former ladies' loo. This will be unisex and the former gents loo will be used as a store and will accommodate the stairs up to the first floor. The toilet has a new hot water heater, a hand drying machine and a small wattage heater to protect the water pipes from freezing in the winter.

In the courtyard, the stage and canopy have been removed, walls have been painted and a lot of repairs to rotten woodwork have been made. A new window is about to be installed to replace the current rotten frame, and repairs have been made to the door frame of the Yarn Barn.

The kitchenette in the Yarn Barn is now finished, and this too has an electric water heater and some useful cupboards for crockery etc. We also have two panel radiators fitted and two ceiling mounted LED strip lights which provide excellent lighting. It is very likely that this facility will be used for church events during the period before the Dove itself is ready, so we are very pleased with the renovations. The quarry tiles on the floor had been adversely affected by the previous brewing activities, with a lot of limescale from the keg washing process, but with quite a lot of scrubbing and scraping it is now looking almost perfect.

We intend to open the Yarn Barn to the public for craft activities starting in the first week of June. We'll be starting with craft demonstrations on Mondays and Have a Go sessions on Wednesdays – see the separate notice in this month's Parish News. Once we get started, we'll be able to extend the opening hours as required.

Freda and Alison felandamh298@gmail.com



Several of us have been meeting together in the Parish Hall on Wednesday evenings over the last couple of months to discuss church integration into our community. It was well said by an archbishop that the Church was the only institution in the world that existed entirely for those who are not yet its members. If church were merely another club amongst the many in Kington, then it would be of little interest to most of us beyond its high days and festivals.

Studying national social material and surveys the Church Urban Fund has designed a series of workshops under the title Growing Good. All material is accessible at <https://growing-good.org.uk/> It is a straightforward idea with unlimited reach. Why should anyone bother learning about God, eternal life, Jesus and the Holy Spirit in a world most of us find pretty busy already?

Perhaps Jesus sets us a good example right from the start. He taught and argued at the temple, and he also had many friends whom he clearly loved and cared for in the community around him. Women or men, the healthy and the sick; he was often there with them. In studying Growing Good we have been challenged to get out and recognise and encourage the spirituality already in our community. Schools, businesses, sports clubs, book clubs; God is there already. Wild Church or Messy Church, Lego Club or Holiday Club; spiritual hunger is being kindled!

Any innovative ideas or offers of help, let us know.

Rob and Trish MacCurrach



St. Peter's Church Titley

Readers

7th 8.30am Jeremy.

21st 10am Judith

Flowers

Flowers for June: Jill

Best Wishes

We send our prayers and best wishes for a speedy recovery to Vera Sexton who is in hospital following a stroke and also to John Turner who is still in hospital.

Church AGM.

At the recent Church AGM I was re-elected as churchwarden. I would like to thank all my fellow members of the PCC who are always there to lend a hand with anything that needs to be done. I also include the many who are not on the PCC but do so much good work for the Church. It makes my job a lot easier. Finally, I would like to thank Rev Sally Welch for her constant support.

Village Fete

A date for your diary is our Village Fete which is always held on the 2nd Saturday in August. This year's date is Saturday 9th August. If you have a great idea for a stall or can help out in any way, please get in contact with Mel George on 07584420288. All proceeds from the fete are divided between the church and village hall.

Many thanks

Dick



St Thomas a Becket, Huntington

As mentioned in last month's *Parish News*, the rotten oak barge boards to the east end elevation of the church were replaced during February, so as not to upset the wild bees who had been in residence for many decades around the purlins in the gable end. Bee activity was seen in early spring, but a few days ago Fiona took the photo below, which shows the colony has not been affected by the work and is as strong as ever. All being well, the bees will be strong enough to defend their colony against the woodpeckers, and no damage will be caused to the new woodwork. This will also alleviate any ingress by squirrels into the roof space.



The cost of the repair work came to £2,600. A few days after submission of last month's article, a generous contribution was made by the Herefordshire Historic Churches Trust, which has been gratefully received by the PCC.

Susan Maiden

Easter Day 2026

It was a great joy to celebrate Holy Communion at St Mary's Kinnerton on Easter Day at 8:30 am. The sun was shining brightly through the east window shedding its warmth and light throughout the church/ It reminded me of another special occasion some 50 odd years ago in the ruins of Leiston Abbey. The theological college held an Easter Retreat every year and students were strongly advised to attend at least one Easter retreat during their time at Queen's Theological College, Birmingham.

I well remember the Easter Retreat held at Leiston Abbey in Suffolk. I set off from Old Sodbury in Gloucestershire in my black and yellow 1932 Austin 7. It was an epic journey of some 300 miles. Enroute, I was passed by members of staff and fellow students in their modern cars. At various points along the way, I saw them stop off at roadside cafes for lunch and afternoon tea. Meanwhile I plodded on, stopping only for petrol and a quick sandwich.

Easter Day morning saw us gathered in the ruins of Leiston Abbey at sunrise to celebrate a special Easter morning Eucharist with the sun shining through the ruins of the east window.

Growing in faith is rather like a journey, at times we experience the spiritual and physical delight of God's presence with that keeping us going along our journey, highlighted by these very special moments.

Yours Sincerely

Tony Jardine

St Mary's Church Kington

ORGAN RECITAL



Friday 12th June 7.00 pm

Roger Judd

Hereford Diocesan Organ Advisor
Organist of St Michael's Tenbury Wells
Former Organist of St George's Windsor

Tickets at the door: £12.00
(including refreshments)

Reader Writes

Was it really four in the morning that the old King had first been woken? But he was delighted; the black redstart had returned at last, singing its melody on the palace rooves. It hid behind chimneys and sang sweetly from the first hint of dawn. At last he had breakfasted, taken leave of the Queen and their daughter, and headed down the winding steps. He lingered as usual on the palace wall overlooking the beech forest. Red-rumped swallows and house martins were busy building nests under the eaves, and at last he heard the heavy drumming of the black woodpecker. How he loved the forests and the meadows above them, where the cuckoo called and the mountain flowers danced.

But the King had a heavy heart and had made up his mind to go down to the Abbey to seek prayer and advice from his friends, the monks. It was the barons again! Not for them the delights of spring and a forest echoing to the cry of woodpeckers. They only wanted to cut the royal timber, do “deals” and sell it down the valley. They ignored the woodpeckers and goshawks; they cared nothing for the woodmen who made their living in the forest, all in harmony taking modest cuts of timber for their many crafts. But the barons would only measure values in gold that could be carried off and hoarded. Take it now, they thought, and we’ll do a deal or many deals with the Turks.

So he set off on his mission, descending the many steps to the Abbey. He went straight to

the Scriptorium to find Father Marko, who shared his passion for everything that grew or flew or “spoke” in wild tongue like the jackals and wolves. Soon they were sipping strong coffee with sticky Turkish ratluk. The barons, it seems to me, said Father Marko, are either plain greedy or much mistaken. Or indeed I think you mean both said the King. The forest is not ours but God’s, continued Father Marko; in his generous love he set us apart from the animals and called us to

care for the earth as his stewards. “The heavens declare the glory of God, and the sky above proclaims his handiwork” opens Psalm 19.

But the barons don’t care for anything beyond their purses, said the old King. They think our love of nature is just old fashioned sentiment. Neither do they love their neighbour; the woodman and the shepherd and certainly the exotic gypsy are all despised, or of course, pitied. God is God of Church, and the forest and the gold are for us, they think!

Father Marko sighed deeply, poured more coffee from the dzezva and with a twinkle

in his eye, said, Well Sir, you will have to teach them some theology from God’s book of words as well as tutor them in God’s book of works. In the first chapter of Paul’s letter to the Romans we read that God’s eternal power and divine nature are clearly perceived ever since the creation of the world in the things that have been made, so they are without excuse! Bless the woodmen and the woodpeckers. Save us all from the barons, and Lord, bring them to their senses!

Robert MacCurrach

In the first chapter of Paul’s letter to the Romans we read that God’s eternal power and divine nature are clearly perceived ever since the creation of the world in the things that have been made, so they are without excuse!

Kington Parishes: June 2026

Sunday, 7th Trinity 1

Hosea 5:15-6.6, Psalm 50:7-15, Romans 4:13-25, Matthew 9:9-13, 18-26

8.30am:	Holy Communion:	Titley
10.00am:	Holy Communion:	Kington *
6.00pm:	Junior Praise:	Old Radnor
6.00pm:	Praise and Prayer Evening:	Kington

Sunday, 14th Trinity 2

Exodus 19:2-8a, Psalm 100, Romans 5:1-8, Matthew 9:35-10:8

8.30am:	Holy Communion:	Huntington
10.00am:	Holy Communion:	Kington *
11:30am	Holy Communion:	Old Radnor
3.00pm:	Wild Church:	Kington

Sunday, 21st Trinity 3

Jeremiah 20:7-13, Psalm 69:8-11, Romans 6:1b-11, Matthew 10:24-39

10.00am:	Holy Communion:	Titley
10.00am:	Morning Praise:	Kington *
6.00pm:	Evening Prayer:	Old Radnor

Sunday, 28th Trinity 4

Jeremiah 28:5-9, Psalm 89:1-4, 15-18, Romans 6:12-end, Matthew 10:40-end

10.00am:	Holy Communion:	Kington *
6.00pm:	Evening Prayer:	Kinnerton
6.00pm:	Sung Evensong:	Huntington

* Live-streamed services

WEEK DAY SERVICES

Morning Prayer takes place at 9am in Kington every Monday, Wednesday and Friday, and Evening Prayer at 4pm on Mondays. All are welcome.

If you or a loved one are unable to make the services at St Mary's but would appreciate prayers or Communion by extension at home, please contact Phillippa (the Curate).

6 God by Numbers

In **6** days, God created the cosmos. On the final day, God created humankind in their image, and the following day, God enjoyed a well-deserved rest! Hebrew slaves worked for **6** years, gaining freedom in the seventh. Land, worked for **6** years, rested fallow in the seventh.

As the children of Israel journeyed through the wilderness, God provided manna from heaven to nourish them on earth. Only on the **sixth** day, which became known as the day of preparation for the Sabbath that followed, could extra be gathered and kept overnight without it rotting. This provision enabled them to rest as God also rested from kitchen duty! On the **sixth** day of the week, the day of preparation, Jesus, the bread of life, was broken for us so we could enter God's rest.

The **sixth** letter, and number, of the Hebrew alphanumeric system is Vav. It is written like a hook. A hook that the Hebrews see as attaching heaven and earth. Jesus says, "Come to me, all you who are weary and heavy laden, and I will give you rest. For my yoke is easy and my burden is light." An apprentice ox is partnered with an experienced oxen by being yoked or hooked to it. Being hooked to Jesus brings us his rest! He takes the load and leads us in the way of peace. Jesus embodied his prayer: "Your will be done on earth as in heaven." He connected the two, and this is also the work we are called to rest in, hooking heaven to earth!

Robert MacCurrach and David Stearns

Kington Art and Craft Market

The next Art and Craft Market will be on

Saturday 20th June
9:30a.m. – 3.00p.m.

at the Market Hall, Kington.

In May we have several new crafters joining us plus our regulars.

Kington Art & Craft Market offers a wide variety of unique items from different local Artists and Crafters. We have something for everyone. Our stalls offer sewn, crochet & knitted items; paper-craft, cards; pottery, basketry, felted items, jewellery, honey products vintage tools and much more. So please put the date in your diary, pop along to see us and support local artists and crafters in their work.

***We look forward to seeing
you on 20th June.***

Kathryn Moore – 2026 Winner of the Christine Forrester Memorial Prize



I knew of the Christine Forrester Prize, that it was formed to enable creative people in Kington (of which there are many) to showcase their work enriching the community. I hadn't given the award a second thought; the appearance of Annie Vickerstaff in the studio at closing on the Saturday, followed by Bob Widdowson, promptly followed by Andy Compton with his camera was no particular surprise...until they made the announcement. Astonished, red-faced and delighted! Thank you to the judges, (Paul Barnes included), for the festival committee who have curated a superb festival this year (record numbers attended from countrywide), but most importantly, for Kington. We have so much to offer here...and yes, for a small market town we do indeed pull out all the stops...it is something to shout about. Thank you everyone.

Kathryn Moore

Following the recent Marches Makers Festival 2026 it was such a surprise and delight to be awarded the Christine Forrester Memorial Prize for contributions made artistically and creatively to the community of Kington.

Approaching my seventh year of residing in Kington they have been the happiest of years. On arriving I rented the empty premises on Church Steet, making it the Kat and Fiddle Studio. In no time it was obvious folk liked the style of my work - local views of which people recognised.

Getting involved with H.Arts (the annual county open studio event), the Kington Walking Festival, resident artist at Hergest Croft Gardens in 2023, plus group exhibitions locally, as well as the Marches Makers Festivals have all contributed to really feeling part of this community. What has, and continues to be, so humbling and cheering is the amount of local people that call in to the studio - introduce themselves and have a natter.

KINGTON COMMUNITY LUNCH CLUB

Come and enjoy a 2-course meal
in a friendly environment with
other local seniors at:

Kington Parish Hall

(HR5 3AG)

at 12:30 p.m.

Cost is £6

We meet on the

3rd Wedne

sday of each month.

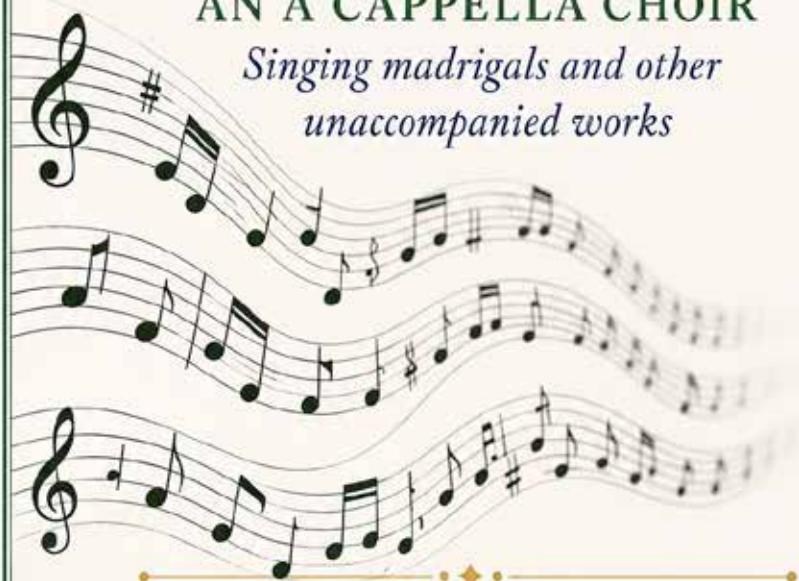
Next lunch is on 17th June

Contact: Chris 07790 288694

Marches Voices

AN A CAPPELLA CHOIR

*Singing madrigals and other
unaccompanied works*



MEETING
TUESDAYS AT 2.00
➔ FROM 2ND JUNE ➔

Kington Parish Hall

HR5 3AG

No audition but ability to read music useful

MONTHLY MUSINGS

Walking is, I reckon, not only to be taken as the best regular exercise in the world, but also as a wonderful opportunity to be in contact with one's true self and one's environment. When we three go for a walk, we are often silent, may sometimes even *Stand and stare*, or, when as youngsters we learnt in road drill, to *Stop, look and listen!* And as we usually have a camera with us, we take photographs to stick in, and write about, in Giles' A4 school-work diary.

One morning recently, for example, we set off for a walk taking with us our elevenses, to visit a couple of my favourite destinations, rather like pilgrimages these, to places where I expect to experience silence and an ambience of holy presence: the pool in Park Wood and the summit of Castle Twts.

Of that pool I've written before. Giles and I took coffee there throughout Covid on Mondays almost without fail. It is a very special place for me, so just let me share with you this poem about it:

The Overflowing Pool

This overflowing pool, this font, for such it is, of love, is fed by God, who first loved us, that we in turn might overflow, by grace, with love for others.

Behold, a sylvan temple!

The vaulted sky above supported is by pillars, trunks of pine, which rise to where beech branches intertwine, to make green leafy clerestories where silver sunbeams dance and shine. And all's reflected in the pool below and, (here's a marvel) the shallow water

mirrors back the light with all the pillars and the vault imaged in all their height. For love goes deep as do the roots of these up-towering trees.

And where it overflows, a sluice-way takes it out beneath the aisle whence, as it goes, it splashes love abroad the while.

And silence! O the silence! Silence which invades the soul, captures and fills the listening ear, Silence which can be felt, which you can hear.

And yet there is no sound, save from the leafy canopy above, where sings the avian choir, whose song of love by contrast only serves to make that silence more profound.

So listen, listen, and you perchance may hear, as once the prophet did, God's still small voice, sound of sheer silence, heard in prayer, beside the overflowing pool of love discovered there.

The path to Twts Castle continues to a kissing gate, opening onto three long footpaths which led us in turn past fields of growing cereal crops; footpaths offering beautiful views and leading us along to a slightly tricky entrance by gates, bridges and steps, well provisioned with aids however, up onto the grassy slopes which we climbed to the summit, where we enjoyed our elevenses, views and the silent holiness. But that will have to wait until another time.

Denis Parry.

Not a Proper Gardener (Part 63)

Today is May 6th, and the end of an exceptionally dry April, but a month of amazing blossom! I'm so glad that when we moved here 26 years ago, I planted so many fruit trees – apples, pears, plums, damson, vine, quince, fig, crab apple, medlar, mulberry – and soft fruits. The jungle resembles an orchard, a mass of beautiful blossom only just beginning to drop. *Even if none of it produces any fruit it will have been worth its weight by the beauty it has given.* And we are still eating some of last year's apples from the garage.

And it's not only fruit blossom. As I look out of my study window, I see the James Grieve white apple blossom framed by deep red camellia flowers, an archway thickly clothed with pale pink clematis, all overlooked by a tall yellow laburnum in full flower. *What a feast for the eyes! Reminds me of Michael Portillo, save that in nature such mixed colours really do go OK together!*

Emma has been busy doing what I would now struggle with in the garden. She got the ladder out and mended the roof of the cage and planted out the dozen runner bean plants I had grown in coir pots on a windowsill, and *she remembered to start them climbing anticlockwise up the sticks (clockwise in the southern hemisphere, I wonder?).* And now I've a dozen sunflowers ready to plant on the outside wall of the cage where they can get a bit of support. The broad beans already planted out are now in flower, some in the



greenhouse, where we hope they will mature before it is time to put in the tomatoes.

The kale has finally started to sprout in the vegetable cage, just as it is needed for the protection of other crops, such as beans and peas. Emma will be very sad if the kale must be uprooted. Still, she has found a few unexpected parsnips to put into soup.

There is a frog in the pond...probably it has eaten most of the tadpoles. The ones rescued and put in a tub survive, though there aren't many. Emma thinks she spotted a froglet in there the other day (with little legs forming) and has made an easy escape route for it.

She is taking extra care with the hygiene around bird food and water following the RSPB report, though wonders how the blackbirds are meant to be provided for if solely using hanging feeders. Some of ours are eating wrinkled apples from our autumnal store. One of the fledglings has learnt to run and hide in between two large plant pots at the first sign of trouble. *The thrush has been busy smashing snails to bits on a handy pebble. She seems to prefer yellow, grey and white striped ones. Will there be any left for the hedgehogs?* Two or three are feasting on calci worms every night.

Happy gardening, Denis.

OAK | Open Arms Kingston May events

Events and opening at The Oxford Arms, Kingston, June 2026.

Details for all events on our website (openarmskington.co.uk).

Tel: 07301081444, email info@openarmskington.co.uk.



Tuesday 2nd June, 6-9pm. *Opening of the Rotherwas Together* exhibition in The Oxford's barn, featuring details of the brave women who worked at the Rotherwas munitions factory during both wars, and the remarkable story of the Rotherwas women's football team. Bar open throughout. Exhibition will remain open during our opening hours from 2nd June - 1st August. Free

Wednesday 3rd June, 10am-12.30pm. *Sunflower Social* at Places of Welcome. A hidden disabilities support group and network, meeting in The Oxford's barn on the first Wednesday of the month during our regular Places Of Welcome opening hours. Free.

Friday 5th June, 11am-2pm. *Antiques evaluation* event with Halls Auctioneers. Donation of £2 per item valued.

Wednesday 10th June, 10am-12.30pm. *Dementia Matters* at Places of Welcome. Support group and network for people affected by dementia, meeting in The Oxford's barn on the second Wednesday of the month during our regular Places Of Welcome opening hours. Free.

Saturday 13th June, from 5pm. *The 50th Anniversary Kingston Wheelbarrow Race!* Food available from RJ's Smokeshack. Bar open throughout. Free.

Friday 26th June, 6-10pm. *Quiz night* at The Oxford Arms. Teams of max 4 people, £3pp entry, cash prize for the winning team. Bar open throughout.

Sunday 28th June, 2-4pm. *Creative Workshop* at The Oxford Arms. This month's activity is watercolour designs! Payment by donation (suggested £5). Live 100 Club draw at 3pm. Bar and café open throughout.

Regular opening hours in June:

Places of Welcome at The Oxford Arms, every Wednesday morning in June, 10am-12.30pm

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June

Please get in touch if your group is within a 10 mile radius of Kingston and would like to be added to a small waiting list who will be offered any vacancies as they arise

Rita Langford

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Adrian Wilcox

kingtoncommunityshop@outlook.com

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03-Jun Eardisland Bowling Club

10-Jun Kinnerton Village Hall and WI

17-Jun Kingston Community Choir

24-Jun New Radnor Community Centre

News From the Museum

Glove Making in Kington

It is lost in the mist of time whoever thought of putting together and sewing two pieces of suede or heavier leather to make a pair of gloves.

Linen gloves were found in the tomb of Tutankhamen, proving gloves were worn in ancient Egypt for carrying out rough work. Archaeologists claim that prehistoric cave dwellers also wore crude gloves. William Shakespeare's father was a glove maker.

It is thought that gloves were not made in England until the tenth or eleventh century, after which time they were much sought after as a fashion item, also for the protection it gave to the hands in all weathers or for carrying out rough work. There are many paintings of noble people showing off finely embroidered gloves/ gauntlets as a status symbol. Gloves have evolved as the ladies favoured lace ones for summer, long/short ones for a ball, in fact in all different materials as we can purchase today.

Glove making in Kington is recorded from the seventh to the ninth century. It gave employment to people in at least 12 parishes including Radnorshire,

Records show there were sixty glove makers in Kington, the earliest being a Richard Luther, who in 1664 was buried in the church yard.

The Allington family worked from 1652 to 1719, when glove making was at its peak. Others involved were Williams, Taylor,

Scandrett and Lilliwall families from 17th to 19th century, where there it became a cottage industry or a workshop setting based in Kington. There are records that show that a building alongside Sun Lane was used for the trade, whether for storage or to sell off the gloves it is not known. Parry records how the glove trade was carried on by several respectable individuals in the town in 1820 and a lesser extent to a later date.

John Duggan High Street, John Edwards of Bridge Street, John & Thomas Griffiths of Edbrook, (Headbrook) Walter Hall High Street, Willis Lewis Duke Street, Richard Rogers High Street, M & Thomas Stephens, Church Street were listed in 1835, by 1851 no glovers were noted in Piggot's Directory. All these gentlemen are recorded as having other businesses as well.

The last Glover listed in Kington is James Smith of Wishlades Row who died in 1882, also a carpenter, and Henry Scandrett's son, who went to Australia.

The Guild paid fifteen pence to hire Leominster Town Hall to conduct their business. Both Kington and Leominster glove making industries were in decline by 1840's.

The importation of French made gloves into the country at a cheaper rate caused the industry to die.

In 1946 the firm Dent, Allcroft Co had revived the business in Leominster, training the girls in South Street, before transferring them to the main workshop in Corn Square, where some 30 girls were employed.

Kington Museum is 40 years old this June, having grown into a little gem, which visitors love. A big thank you to all the people who have supported us.

Wendy Jones

Kington Benefice Pilgrim Path Project 2026

Guided Circular Pilgrim Trails from our churches

The churches of the Kington Benefice offer you the hospitality of their buildings, which are open daily and the opportunity to explore the local environment along ancient ways, through outstanding landscapes.

We invite you to make these short pilgrim journeys in a spirit of openness to what it might offer, delight in the countryside through which you travel and companionship with those who have travelled this way before and will do so after you.

Accompanied by experienced guides, there will be opportunities for conversation and reflection, encounter and exploration.



Start Time: 1.45 pm for prompt 2.00 pm start

Meeting at: Church Door

Refreshments available on return

21 June	St Stephen's Old Radnor LD8 2RL
19 July	St Peter's Titley HR5 3RR
16 August	St Thomas à Becket Huntington HR5 3PY
20 September	St Mary's Kington HR5 3AG

Free to join, but booking essential as places limited

Booking: Judith Pollard - wotzpollard@aol.com

Enquiries: Sally Welch - vicar@kingtonparishes.org.uk

Telephone: 07974439630

Caring for God's Acre

How to read your meadow!

June is the perfect month to enjoy grassland flowers and many of us have a 'pocket meadow' of long, flowery grass in our churchyards, chapel yards, cemeteries and also our gardens. As well as being beautiful these small pitstops for pollinators can have great wildlife value within both urban and rural landscapes. Sometimes however, a meadow area seems to have less and less flowers as the years go by and it can be hard to know why. If this is the case in a meadow that you manage the grasses may give you a clue as to the cause of this problem.

In a sward of coarse grasses all but the largest, strongest wildflowers will be swamped and lost, their seeds will not reach soil to germinate and small plants will be overshadowed and pushed out.

Native grasses can be divided into fine and coarse species. The fine grasses are shorter, about 30cms, with fine, needle-thick stems and small leaves. Fine grasses allow plenty of room for wildflowers too. Common species include Meadow grasses, Bents and Fescues.

The coarse grasses are larger, sometimes over 1m high, with thicker stems, broad leaves and a tussocky base. In a sward of coarse grasses all but the largest, strongest wildflowers will be swamped and lost, their seeds will not reach soil to germinate and small plants will be overshadowed and pushed out. The main coarse



grasses are Cocksfoot, False Oat-grass and Yorkshire Fog.

Whilst a flowery meadow may contain both fine and coarse grass species, if the proportion of coarse grasses increases to more than just occasional plants here and there then you may have a problem. Coarse grasses thrive in places with higher soil fertility and infrequent cutting. If you are cutting your meadow once a year, quite late in the season, this increases fertility and the strength of the coarse grasses. Raking up cuttings is vital for a meadow, if left uncollected the cuttings rot, increasing nutrients and swamping other plants. So, if coarse grasses dominate your meadow then cut more often, earlier in the summer and rake hard so that bare soil is revealed.

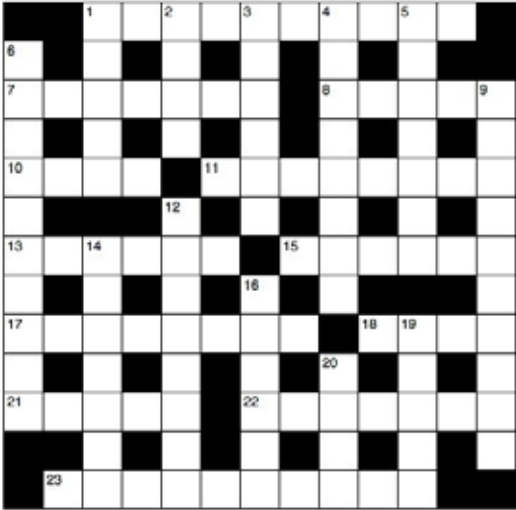
Whilst meadows vary depending on soil, location and weather, a good rule of thumb is to leave a meadow uncut for three to four months and no longer. You can cut in March or April and then again in July or August or, if you don't cut in spring then cut by mid-July. This does mean cutting off some flowers but it really knocks back the coarse grasses, favouring fine ones. After a year or two you will start to see wildflowers return. Also, most meadow plants are perennial so the flowers will still be there even if they didn't set seed and you can always cut around a clump or two of late flowering species.

All the best,

Harriet Carty

Diocesan Churchyard Environmental Advisor

June Crossword



Across

- 1 Evil (Genesis 6:5) (10)
- 7 Musician called for by Elisha when he met the kings of Israel, Judah and Edom (2 Kings 3:15) (7)
- 8 The request that led to the institution of the Lord's Prayer: 'Lord, — us to pray' (Luke 11:1) (5)
- 10 'We are hard pressed on every—'(2Corinthians4:8)(4)
- 11 Fraud (2Corinthians6:8)(8)
- 13 'His troops advance in force;they build a siege ramp against me and — around my tent' (Job 19:12) (6)
- 15 Where Rachel hid Laban's household gods when he searched his daughter's tent (Genesis 31:34) (6)
- 17 'Now about spiritual gifts,brothers,I do not want you to be—' (1 Corinthians 12:1) (8)
- 18 Nomadic dwelling(Genesis26:25)(4)
- 21 'As for man,his days are like—he flourishes like a flower of the field' (Psalm 103:15) (5)
- 22 Or I live (anag.)(7)
- 23 Those guilty of 1 Across(Romans13:4)(10)

Down

- 1 'God so loved the — that he gave his one and only Son' (John 3:16) (5)
- 2 'Away in a manger, no — for a bed' (4)
- 3 Mob ten (anag.) (6)
- 4 'Each — group made its own gods in several towns where they settled' (2 Kings 17:29) (8)
- 5 Began (Luke 9:46) (7)
- 6 Speaking very softly (John 7:32) (10)
- 9 Workers Ruth joined when she arrived in Bethlehem with her mother-in-law Naomi (Ruth 2:3) (10)
- 12 Put in jail(Acts22:19)(8)
- 14 Aceturn(anag.)(7)
- 16 Discharge(Acts21:3)(6)
- 19 'All these—come from inside and make a man "unclean"' (Mark 7:23) (5)
- 20 'Let us rejoice and be glad and — him glory!'(Revelation19:7)(4)

God in the Arts

Editor: *Have you ever thought how an actual church building might provide a series of visual aids to spiritual meditation? The Revd Michael Burgess continues his procession through a church building, this month pausing to consider the significance of the church monuments.*

'He gave us eyes to see them' – Church Monuments

This month as we continue our walk through the church building, we focus on monuments. George Herbert has a poem on this theme which contrasts the body we see represented in marble, but now consigned to dust, with the soul released to perform its eternal devotions. Such monuments are often a reminder of the frailty of life and the certainty of death, symbolised by an hourglass or a skull or classical urns.

In St Cuby's Church, Duloe in Cornwall there is a fine slate memorial of an Elizabethan lady, Anna Coffyn, depicted in a richly embroidered dress with gloves and a prayer book, ready for church. Underneath are the skull and crossbones, a memento mori, a reminder that death has visited even this elegant lady. That sign of death can come as a shock to us when we are committed so much to living and getting the most out of life today. Death intrudes violently into the world we would like.



But in St Bartholomew's Church, Much Marcle in Herefordshire, there is a monument that tells us something of the serenity of death. It is the effigy of Blanche Mortimer, who died in 1347. The church is filled with superb monuments, but this one has its own distinct and moving beauty. The carving of her dress shows buttoned sleeves and a wimple, while one hand holds a rosary. She impresses us with her loveliness, even in the midst of her death.

Leonardo da Vinci wrote, 'While I thought that I was learning how to live, I have been learning how to die.' As we dedicate ourselves to God in this life, we can trust with Blanche Mortimer in the 14th century that His will is for us to be with Him forever. This life is not just our preparation for death: it is our schooling for heaven, and life in heaven means life with God.

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Wordsearch for June 2026

Visit of the Blessed Virgin Mary to Elizabeth – Jun26

Mary - the Virgin Mother of Jesus. Her visit to Elizabeth, when both were pregnant, is a moving account of two humble, ordinary women, suddenly caught up in a great event that would shape world history. Their trusting faith in God and acceptance of His will, shine through.

After Jesus is born, Mary makes few appearances: when the family visits Jerusalem and she loses her Son on the way home; when she urges Him to help the wedding party in Cana with its wine problem; and when Jesus

gives her into the keeping of the beloved disciple when He is dying on the cross. Mary's last appearance is in Acts, just before Pentecost.

Mary, chosen to be the mother of Jesus Christ, one who is both God and Man, holds a unique place in history. Down the centuries that have followed, the Church has paid special honour to Mary – and well deserved it is. "All generations shall call me blessed..."

<i>Mary</i>	<i>Ordinary</i>	<i>Family</i>	<i>Beloved</i>	<i>Unique</i>
<i>Virgin</i>	<i>World</i>	<i>Jerusalem</i>	<i>Disciples</i>	<i>Place</i>
<i>Mother</i>	<i>History</i>	<i>Wedding</i>	<i>Dying</i>	<i>Centuries</i>
<i>Elizabeth</i>	<i>Great</i>	<i>Cana</i>	<i>Cross</i>	<i>Church</i>
<i>Pregnant</i>	<i>Event</i>	<i>Wine</i>	<i>Keeping</i>	<i>blessed</i>



Easy Sudoku

2				6		8	4	1
	4	1			3			
			8				5	
		5	9			6	8	
	7		3	2	4		1	
	1	4			6	3		
	3				5			
			1			4	9	
1	9	6		7				2

Intermediate Sudoku

1	5							
					6	4		
	3	6		2	9	1		
	7			1	2			
8	9						4	1
			3	9			2	
		7	9	4		2	3	
		5	7					
							8	6

God in the Sciences

T*his series is written by
Dr Ruth M. Bancewicz, who is Church
Engagement Director at The Faraday
Institute for Science and Religion in Cambridge.
Ruth writes on the positive relationship between
Science and Christian faith.*

A Bucket of Tadpoles: Springtime, Curiosity, and the Theology of Science

When I was nearly three, I knocked a bucket of tadpoles all over the patio. Those unfortunate creatures must have been collected to educate my brother and I on where frogs came from, but a toddler can't just stand by and watch. Can I see up close? Or maybe I was 'helpfully' moving it to another place. I just remember doing something I shouldn't have done, and tadpoles on the ground. I was sad that I wouldn't get to see those creatures grow up.



I might have been great at destroying things when I was a child (my family would probably say I still am), but I absolutely love watching living things up close. The more I learn, the more my sense of wonder grows. For a tadpole to become a frog, large sections of its gut, salivary glands and muscles must die, as well as the gills. The cells in those

tissues are programmed to curl up and disintegrate, and are then swallowed up by a specialised kind of white blood cell. Legs grow from small sacs of cells on the tadpole's body, and one of my textbooks says that 'The nervous system is also remodelled' - which I suspect is a bit of an understatement.

This knowledge removes a little of the mystery of how a tadpole turns into a frog, but there is plenty more to discover. These few details also reveal the cleverness of the process. Metamorphosis is surprisingly common in the animal kingdom. How is that an efficient way to grow up, or is efficiency not the most important thing for an animal?

Scientists are essentially grown-ups who are still very much in touch with their inner two-year-old. They refuse to stop asking questions, even when finding an answer becomes decidedly more awkward than opening a textbook.

Many scientists are people of faith, and this also drives their questioning. They believe that God created a world that was very good, that the purpose of all Creation is to praise Him, that we are made in God's image, and that we are tasked with looking after Creation. So Christians, of all people, should be enjoying and investigating our surroundings. These are the bones of a theology of science which serves some of us very well, and keeps us looking into things like buckets of frogs - that is, until a two-year-old comes and knocks them over.

Answers Page

Easy Sudoku

2	5	3	7	6	9	8	4	1
8	4	1	2	5	3	7	6	9
7	6	9	8	4	1	2	5	3
3	2	5	9	1	7	6	8	4
6	7	8	3	2	4	9	1	5
9	1	4	5	8	6	3	2	7
4	3	2	6	9	5	1	7	8
5	8	7	1	3	2	4	9	6
1	9	6	4	7	8	5	3	2

Crossword

		W	I	C	K	E	D	N	E	S	S	
W		O		R		N		A		T		
H	A	R	P	I	S	T		T	E	A	C	H
I		L		B		O		I		R		A
S	I	D	E		I	M	P	O	S	T	E	R
P				I		B		N		E		V
E	N	C	A	M	P		S	A	D	D	L	E
R		E		P		U		L				S
I	G	N	O	R	A	N	T		T	E	N	T
N		T		I		L		G		V		E
G	R	A	S	S		O	L	I	V	I	E	R
		U		O		A		V				S
	W	R	O	N	G	D	O	E	R	S		

Intermediate Sudoku

1	5	8	4	3	7	6	9	2
7	2	9	1	8	6	4	5	3
4	3	6	5	2	9	1	7	8
3	7	4	8	1	2	5	6	9
8	9	2	6	7	5	3	4	1
5	6	1	3	9	4	8	2	7
6	1	7	9	4	8	2	3	5
2	8	5	7	6	3	9	1	4
9	4	3	2	5	1	7	8	6

Wordsearch

C	H	U	R	C	H	A	G	O	I	W	N	D	T	C
C	I	N	N	U	T	N	I	I	S	T	C	N	R	N
P	T	G	I	I	L	D	D	E	R	E	O	I	I	
S	E	I	R	P	O	O	P	E	E	V	S	G	E	R
V	G	C	E	N	T	U	R	I	E	S	E	Z	G	S
R	R	E	H	R	W	D	E	D	L	L	S	R	S	I
R	K	M	T	U	I	G	N	I	D	D	E	W	N	
N	E	S	O	L	C	S	N	F	Z	N	R	V	L	H
Y	R	A	M	E	A	C	A	E	A	N	A	H	I	B
B	E	V	I	R	G	I	N	L	B	M	I	R	L	T
A	E	D	E	R	W	P	T	C	E	S	I	B	Y	J
I	N	D	E	V	O	L	E	B	T	M	U	L	C	R
E	C	A	L	P	R	E	E	O	H	T	C	E	Y	L
C	T	I	C	Y	L	S	R	S	E	L	W	E	E	I
E	S	H	I	E	D	Y	I	N	G	A	I	A	K	Y

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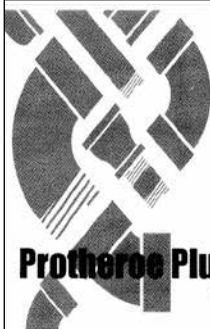
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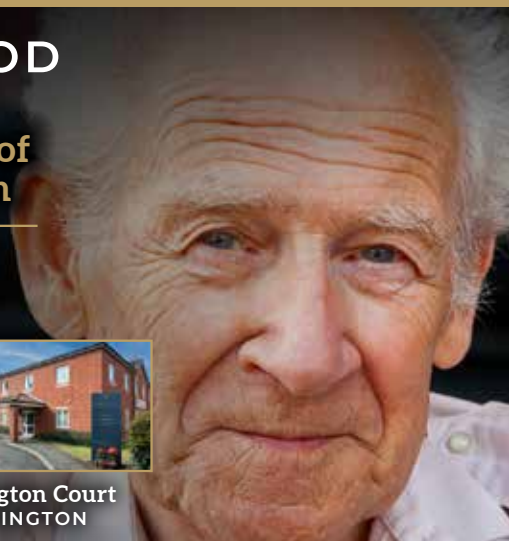
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Kington Mill St

Titiley

Knighton Bus Station

Knighton Library

41	41	41	41	41	41
M>F	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa
06:10	08:20	10:10	12:10	15:20	17:30
06:18	08:28	10:19	12:19	15:19	17:39
06:40	-	10:48	12:45	15:55	18:05
	08:53	10:54	12:47	15:57	-

36

Knighton Offa's Dyke

Knighton Bus Station

Titiley

Kington Mill St

41	41	41	41	41	41
M>F	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa
06:38	09:07	11:09	13:03	16:13	18:03
06:42	09:11	11:13	13:07	16:17	18:07
07:04	09:35	11:35	13:34	16:39	18:27
07:14	09:45	11:45	13:44	16:49	18:37

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Monday to Sunday

Llandrindod Wells Railway Station Crossgates Kington. Mill St arr	461 M>F	461 C	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa
		06:38		09:00		11:08	12:08		13:08	14:08		15:50	16:00	16:11	16:46	17:10	17:37	18:50	
		06:44		09:06		11:14	12:14		13:14	14:14		15:53	16:11	16:46	17:11	17:38	18:05	18:56	
		07:13		09:45		11:45	12:45		13:45	14:45		15:55	16:58	17:07	17:35	18:09	18:22	19:22	
Kington, Mill St dep Hereford Old Market Hereford Station	06:40		07:20	08:50	09:50	10:50	11:50	12:50	13:50	14:50	15:50	16:58	17:10	18:02	18:07	18:58	19:37	20:24	22:00
	07:32		08:30	09:47	10:53	11:47	12:47	13:46	14:47	15:47	16:49	16:53	17:00	17:00	17:00	17:00	17:00	17:00	Request
	07:37		08:35	09:52	10:58	11:52	12:52	13:55	14:52	15:52	16:55	16:58	17:07	17:35	18:09	18:22	19:20	20:27	Request
	461 M>Sa	461 M>F	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa
Hereford Station Hereford Maylord Kington Mill St arr		07:38	09:00	10:00	11:00	12:00	13:00	14:00	15:00	16:00	16:15	16:30	16:30	16:30	16:37	16:37	16:37	17:00	20:45
		07:42	09:07	10:07	11:07	12:07	13:07	14:07	15:07	16:07	16:25	16:37	16:37	16:37	16:37	16:37	16:37	16:37	20:52
		08:45	10:05	11:10	12:05	12:09	13:05	14:05	15:05	16:05	17:05	17:10	17:35	18:05	18:05	18:05	18:09	18:09	21:48
Kington Mill St dep Crossgates Llandrindod Wells Station	07:50		10:10	11:10	12:10	13:10	14:10		16:10	17:15h	17:35	18:10							
	08:21		10:41	11:41	12:41	13:41	14:41		16:41	17:45h	18:06	18:41							
	08:39		10:47	11:47	12:55	13:47	14:47		16:55	17:52h	18:12	18:47							

Key:

Monday to Saturday

Sundays only

C Operates Hereford College days only

School holidays $M > F$

School holidays + Sat

Please verify with Sargeants for the most up to date timings and if Sunday buses are running on the route you require.

Forthcoming events

<i>June</i>	<i>Time</i>	<i>Event</i>	<i>Venue & Contact</i>
Mon 1 st	12.15 – 1.30pm	Kington Zero Waste	Parish Hall
<i>Repeated weekly</i>			
Mon 1 st	10am – 12pm	Craft Demonstrations Yarn Barn	The Dove, formerly The Wine Vaults
<i>Repeated weekly</i>			
Tues 2 nd	9.15–10.45am	Stay & Play Babies and Toddlers	Parish Hall
<i>Repeated weekly during school term only</i>			
Wed 3 rd	10am – 12pm	‘Have a Go’ craft sessions Yarn Barn	The Dove, formerly The Wine Vaults
<i>Repeated weekly</i>			
Fri 5 th	10am– 11.30am	Kington Zero Waste	Parish Hall
<i>Repeated weekly</i>			
Fri 5 th	7.00pm	‘The Archaeology of the Radnor Valley’ (Talk)	
		Tickets £5 at the door	St Stephen’s Church, Old Radnor LD8 2RH
Sun 7 th	6.00pm	Prayer and Praise Evening	St Mary’s
Tues 9 th	7.00pm	Beetle Drive	Parish Hall
Fri 12 th	7.00pm	Organ Recital by Roger Judd	St Mary’s
		£12 (including refreshments)	
Sat 13 th	6.00pm	Kington Wheelbarrow Race	Kington
		50th Anniversary	
Sun 14 th	3pm – 4.30pm	Wild Church	Kington Vicarage
Wed 17 th	3.30pm	Lego Club	St Mary’s
Sat 20 th	Time TBA	St Mary’s Church Fete	St Mary’s
Sun 21 st		Pilgrim Walk	Old Radnor
Wed 24 th	7.00pm	‘The Most Decorated Soldier in Kington’	The Burton Hotel
Sat 27 th	11.00am	Armed Forces Day Parade	Lady Hawkins School
Sat 27 th	1.00pm	Smokefest	KT Football Club
Sun 28 th	10am – 4pm	Kington Street Market	Kington High St
Sun 28 th	6.00 pm	Choral Evensong (rehearsal at 5.00 pm)	Huntington Church

FOR DETAILS OF CHURCH SERVICES PLEASE SEE KINGTON PARISHES PAGE 9

See also: www.broadsheep.com www.visitherefordshire.co.uk www.kingtontourist.info

If you would like a community event publicised in the Diary please contact:
Rev.Paul.C.Roberts@gmail.com

MATERIAL FOR THE July 2026 PARISH NEWS

by **10th June 2026**

Please send by email (maximum 500 words) to:

pn.kingtonparishes@gmail.com

Note: The cut-off date is always the 10th of the previous month